

# House Caraen

## House Caraen

"FOR THE PROTECTION OF THE LAND AND THE SOULS THAT INHABIT IT"

## Quick Facts

Status: Knight/Dame

Origin: Aicruae (Capital City, Lajazer)

Founded: 8,643 BR

Founder: Milane Caraen

Seat: Caraen Towers, Lajazer (capital city of Aicruae)

Faction: Neutral Faction

House Name Meaning: Gift from the Gods

Spirit Animal: None. House symbol is the Watchtower (two watchtowers with moon).

Colors: Blue (Loyalty, Vigilance, and the Sky)

Wealth: ~68,000 Rern

Military: Over 100,000 men (3rd strongest military in Aicruae, after House Vika and House Patton)

Religion: Rillic

Theme Song: "This Mountain" by Faouzia

## Status By Era

Pre-Empire Era: Knight/Dame. One of three notable noble families living in the capital alongside the royal family. Primary duty: defending the capital city of Lajazer.

Solis's Era: [TBD]

Crandona's Era: [TBD]

Minara's Era: [TBD]

## Why They Matter

House Caraen is what happens when loyalty becomes identity. Founded by an orphan from the slums who owed everything he had to the king who elevated him, the Caraens built their entire existence around one purpose: protecting the royal family and the capital city they call home. They are not wealthy. They are not politically ambitious. They rank among the lowest noble houses in terms of power and money. But they command the third largest military in all of Aicruae, over 100,000 men whose sole job is making sure the capital doesn't fall.

Nobody hates them. Nobody particularly loves them either. As the saying goes, "they're kinda just there." And yet, across centuries, Caraen soldiers have bled and died for the throne without question. Isweyi Caraen refused an offer of escape during the Siege of Highwater and fought for nearly two hours to protect the royal heirs. Oahiat Caraen died at the Battle of GreyNest alongside Dexona Vika, stalling an enemy long enough to turn the tide of a war. Their loyalty has never been in question. Whether the throne has always deserved it is another matter entirely.

## Heraldry

The Crest: A lozenge (diamond-shaped) shield, rotated so its points face up, down, left, and right. The entire field is a solid cornflower blue. At the center rises a gray stone castle with a central tower crowned by three turrets, flanked by two smaller towers, all featuring crenellated battlements. In the upper right corner, a small white circle represents the moon watching over the fortress.

Symbolism:

The castle is the Caraen Towers. Not a symbol of a castle. The actual seat of House Caraen, built at the very front of Lajazer, the capital city of Aicruae, positioned so that anything coming for the royal family has to go through them first. Milane Caraen was an orphan from the slums. King Haliour Layern Patton II gave him a title and a purpose, and Milane put his family between the crown and everything that wanted to take it. The castle on this crest isn't a boast about wealth or power. It's a job description. House Caraen exists to stand in front of the city and not move.

The three turrets on the central tower and the two flanking towers show redundancy. Not grandeur. If one position falls, there's another behind it. If that one falls, there's a third. House Caraen commands over 100,000 men, the third strongest military in Aicruae behind only House Vika and House Patton, and every

single one of those soldiers serves one function: hold the line. Isweyi Caraen proved it at the Siege of Highwater when she refused an offer of escape and fought for nearly two hours to protect the royal heirs. Oahiat Caraen proved it at the Battle of GreyNest when he died alongside Dexona Vika buying time that turned the war. The towers don't fall because Caraen soldiers don't leave.

The white moon is the watcher that never sleeps. House Caraen follows Rillic, the faith that says believers exist to fuel the gods' strength and give them a stronger tether to the mortal world. The moon is that tether made visible. It hangs over the fortress the same way the Caraens hang over Lajazer: always present, always watching, whether anyone notices or not. The moon also speaks to what other houses say about them. "No one neither hates nor loves them. They're kinda just there." The moon is kinda just there too. But try navigating without it.

The cornflower blue field is loyalty, vigilance, and the sky. Just one color. No divisions, no secondary fields, no complications. House Caraen doesn't have a spirit animal. They don't have a secondary symbol. They don't have a dual power structure or a famous commercial empire or a legendary weapon. They have blue. One job. One color. One thing they do, and they do it with 100,000 soldiers who will die for a capital city most of them were born in. Blue is the sky over Lajazer. The Caraens live under it, fight under it, and get buried under it. The lozenge shape instead of a traditional shield is worth noting. In real-world heraldry, the lozenge was historically used for women, for non-combatants, for families that held land through service rather than conquest. House Caraen is a knight family. The lowest rank of nobility. They hold 68,000 Rern, which is nothing compared to the houses they stand beside in the capital. They didn't earn their crest through war or wealth. They earned it because a king looked at an orphan and saw something worth keeping. The diamond shape says: we don't carry a warrior's shield. We carry something else. A promise.

House Colors: Blue. Just blue. Loyalty, vigilance, and the sky over the city they protect.

Motto: "For the protection of the land and the souls that inhabit it." The longest motto in Aicruae, and the most literal. There's no metaphor in it. No double meaning. No quiet arrogance dressed up as humility. House Caraen protects the land. House Caraen protects the people living on it. That's the whole motto and the whole house.

Caraen means "Gift from the Gods." Milane was a gift the king received. The family he founded has spent every generation since then trying to be worthy of it. The motto doesn't say "for the protection of the king." It says "the land and the souls that inhabit it." Every soul. Not the noble ones. Not the royal ones. All of them. That's the Rillic faith talking. If you exist to fuel the gods' strength, then every life on that land is sacred fuel. You protect it all or you protect nothing.

It's not a flashy motto. It doesn't fit on a banner the way "Loyal is the hound to the master" does. But it doesn't need to. House Caraen isn't trying to impress anyone. They're trying to keep the city standing. The motto says what it means and means what it says. So does the family.

## **Power & Influence**

### **Source of Power**

Military strength and centuries of loyal service to the crown. House Caraen is not a wealthy noble family and ranks among the lowest in terms of raw power and wealth. Their influence comes from their role as the capital's defenders and their unbroken track record of protecting the royal family.

### **Internal Power Structure**

Traditional patriarchal structure, but similar to House Vika, women are not limited to the sidelines.

### **Military Forces**

Primary duty: Protecting the capital city of Lajazer.

Ranked 3rd in military strength across Aicruae, behind House Vika and House Patton.

Forces: Over 100,000 men ready to defend the city.

### **Lands & Income**

Seat: The Caraen Towers, located at the very front of the town of Lajazer, the capital city of Aicruae. One of three notable noble families living in the capital (alongside the royal family).

House Total Wealth: 68,000 Rern.

Key Industries: [TBD]

## **Alliances & Rivalries**

### **Allied Houses**

House Arvento, Marriage alliance through Philero Caraen and Jomerra Arvento (8,681 BR – 8,639 BR). Both families are members of the Council of the Forsaken.

House Aedria, Both families are members of the Council of the Forsaken.

### **Rival Houses**

[TBD]

### **Royal Connections**

Founded through the direct patronage of King Haliour Layern Patton II, who gifted Milane Caraen his title of nobility. The Caraen family has served as protectors of the royal family ever since.

## **House Culture**

### **Religion**

Rillic. Believers of Rillic hold that they were put on this planet to fuel the gods' strength and give them a stronger tether to the physical/mortal world.

### **Traditions**

[TBD]

### **Values**

[TBD]

### **Reputation**

Very respected. House Caraen is one of the few noble houses to be generally respected rather than feared or hated. They have protected the royal family for

centuries, earning the trust of the nobility. "No one neither hates nor loves them. They're kinda just there."

## History

### Founding (8,643 BR)

Milane Caraen was born an orphan in the slums of Lajazer. He became a sword for hire, and at age 16, was recruited by The Etrai of the royal castle to serve as a knight for the royal family. He caught the attention of King Haliour Layern Patton II, who granted him the title of nobility at age 19, founding House Caraen. Milane became a close personal friend of the king, who was devastated when Milane died.

### Rise to Power

[TBD]

### Major Achievements

Treaty of Oahiat (8,248 BR). A blood treaty named in honor of Oahiat Caraen, who died at the Battle of GreyNest alongside Dexona Vika. The treaty married Maikor of Pireaynea's children to Oahiat's children.

Talta Ikati. Akare Caraen bonded with a minor earth deity and became a Talta Ikati, making her the first woman of Aicruae to hold the position of tower lord (Lady).

Silver Pen. Nadera Caraen earned this literary honor for her work immortalizing her mother Isweyi's heroism through books, songs, and plays.

### Major Disgraces

[TBD]

### Founding Story (Expanded)

[TBD]

### Notable Members

Listed chronologically, from the house's origins onward.

## **Milane Caraen (8,662 BR – 8,600 BR)**

Founder of House Caraen

Name meaning: Long Stretch of Road

Born an orphan in the slums of Lajazer. Became a sword for hire. At 16, he was recruited by The Etrai of the royal castle to become a knight for the royal family. He gained the recognition of King Haliour Layern Patton II and was granted nobility at 19, founding House Caraen. A close personal friend of the king, who was devastated by Milane's death.

"Without his majesty, I would be nothing, a meaningless life among the masses, he gave me purpose and so I shall fight in his honor."

## **Asjart Caraen (8,611 BR – 8,579 BR)**

Knight of Prince Teravian Geraser Patton

Name meaning: Tortoise

Grandson of Milane. Became knight of Prince Teravian Geraser Patton. Deeply loyal to the crown and a dedicated servant to the prince. Asjart died two years before the prince, after which the prince's health deteriorated.

## **Philero Caraen (dates unknown)**

Marriage Alliance with House Arvento

Married Jomerra Arvento, solidifying the relationship between Houses Arvento and Caraen.

## **Oahiat Caraen (8,283 BR – 8,248 BR)**

"Blood Treaty Bearer"

Name meaning: All Hearing

Nurse and soldier. Oahiat battled alongside Dexona Vika at the Battle of GreyNest. Both women died after being badly injured by Maikor of Pireaynea. Though they lost the battle, they stalled Maikor long enough for the Aicruean army to turn the tide of war. The Treaty of Oahiat, a blood treaty that married Maikor's children to Oahiat's children, was named in her honor.

## **Dilion of the Tower (dates unknown)**

Abusive husband, father, and lord who neglected his wife, children, and land.  
Father of Akare and Baciyo Caraen.

## **Baciyo Caraen (8,271 BR – 8,240 BR)**

Name meaning: Rooster

Dilion's only son and heir. Sickly from birth, bedridden and presumed half dead. His father became obsessed with curing him through rituals and sacrifices. One ritual "fixed" him at age 10, but it corrupted his mind. Baciyo grew twisted like his father. He developed an extreme fixation (kink) on pain and was said to have experimented on servants and animals.

## **Akare Caraen (8,265 BR – 8,203 BR)**

First Female Tower Lord (Lady) of Aicruae

Name meaning: Obedient

Youngest daughter of Dilion. Lived in constant fear of her father. At age 23, she bonded with a minor earth deity and became a Talta Ikati. Her position as a Talta Ikati allowed her to become the first woman of Aicruae to hold the position of tower lord (Lady).

## **Basania Caraen (7,996 BR – 7,967 BR)**

"The Jewel of High Society"

Name meaning: Beauty

Well-respected lady known throughout the world for her beauty. A scholar and prized pupil of the Cidet. Basania fell in love with Hailea Kulio (six years her senior) at age 17. She spent her life sending Hailea flowers and gifts and bullying romantic rivals, particularly Takerei. She was the first of Hailea's followers to commit suicide after Hailea's death. Basania killed herself at age 29, days after her birthday. Her nanny found her five days later. She was married and had one son before her death.

## **Isweyi Caraen (7,499 BR – 7,463 BR)**

"The Queen of the Tower"



Name meaning: Night's Child

National hero. Isweyi died protecting the royal family during the Siege of Highwater (7,463 BR). Revolutionists offered her escape, but she refused, striking her sword Relma into one's chest.

"You dare to offer me treason on a silver platter, I am Isweyi of the Caraen lineage, I was born of the tower, and I shall die by the tower."

She fought for nearly two hours and died saving an heir to the throne.

## **Nadera Caraen (7,465 BR – 7,415 BR)**

Silver Pen Recipient

Name meaning: Amber

Daughter of Isweyi. Only two years old during the Siege of Highwater and never knew her mother well. Nadera worked tirelessly creating books, songs, and plays about her mother's victory, immortalizing Isweyi as a national hero. She was a talented writer who earned the Silver Pen.

## **Strengths & Weaknesses**

### **Known For**

Military defense of the capital city, centuries of unbroken loyalty to the crown, generally respected by the nobility, and producing soldiers and protectors who die for their duty without hesitation.

### **What They Lack**

[TBD]

### **Vulnerabilities**

[TBD]

## **Role in Narrative**

Book Appearances: [TBD]

Plot Significance: [TBD]

Key Members in Story: [TBD]

## Cross-References

House Patton, House Arvento, House Aedria, House Vika, King Haliour Layern Patton II, Prince Teravian Geraser Patton, Milane Caraen, Asjart Caraen, Oahiat Caraen, Dexona Vika, Maikor of Pireaynea, Akare Caraen, Dilion of the Tower, Baciyo Caraen, Basania Caraen, Hailea Kulio, Takerei, Isweyi Caraen, Nadera Caraen, Capital City of Lajazer, Eastern Aicruae, Town of Haleker, Battle of GreyNest, Siege of Highwater (7,463 BR), Treaty of Oahiat (8,248 BR), Talta Ikati, Silver Pen, The Etrai, The Cidet, Relma (Sword), Rillic (Religion), Council of the Forsaken, Neutral Faction

## Keywords

House Caraen, Caraen, Gift from the Gods, Knight, Dame, Capital City, Lajazer, Caraen Towers, Neutral Faction, For the Protection of the Land and the Souls That Inhabit It, Watchtower, Blue, Rillic, Rern, Milane Caraen, Asjart Caraen, Philero Caraen, Jomerra Arvento, Oahiat Caraen, Treaty of Oahiat, Dilion of the Tower, Akare Caraen, Talta Ikati, Baciyo Caraen, Basania Caraen, Hailea Kulio, Takerei, Isweyi Caraen, Queen of the Tower, Relma, Siege of Highwater, Nadera Caraen, Silver Pen, The Etrai, The Cidet, Council of the Forsaken, House Arvento, House Aedria, House Patton, House Vika, Dexona Vika, Maikor of Pireaynea, Battle of GreyNest, King Haliour Layern Patton II, Prince Teravian Geraser Patton, Tower Lord, Tower Lady, First Female Tower Lord